MERAZ × OpenLake

Alpha ARENA

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

BUILD. PREDICT. OUTSMART.



COMPETITION	DURATION	TEAM SIZE
AI Trading Arena	3 hours	2 participants

The AI Trading Arena challenges teams to build, test, and evaluate an AI-powered trading strategy. Compete fairly, use permitted resources, and test on an unseen market.

RULEBOOK AT A GLANCE

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SECTION 01

1. Competition Objective

- Build an AI-powered or algorithmic trading strategy using permitted data and tools.
- Use Python, machine learning, statistics, time-series analysis, technical analysis, or other approved methods.
- Test and refine the strategy, then submit it for evaluation on an unseen dataset or simulation.
- The event uses virtual trading only unless the organizers explicitly announce otherwise.

SECTION 02

2. Team Formation

- Each team must have 2 participants.
- A participant may register with only one team.
- Each team must nominate one team leader to handle communication and submission.
- Teams must not change their membership after registration without organizer approval.

SECTION 03

3. Three-Hour Schedule

The event runs for three hours. Each stage follows the same schedule for every team.

STAGE	TIME	ACTIVITY
1. Briefing and rules	15 minutes	We explain the challenge, resources, constraints, and scoring.
2. Strategy development	75 minutes	Analyse the data and build the trading strategy.
3. Testing and refinement	35 minutes	Test, debug, and improve the strategy using permitted data.
4. Final submission	15 minutes	Submit code and required documentation before the deadline.
5. Unseen-market evaluation	25 minutes	Run eligible submissions under the same evaluation conditions.
6. Results and closing	15 minutes	Verify results, announce rankings, and close the event.

SECTION 04

4. Data, Tools, and Resources

- All teams will receive the same official starting resources and training data.
- Use only approved datasets, libraries, APIs, software, and computing resources.
- Do not access, request, share, or attempt to discover hidden evaluation data before the final test.
- Do not use future information or data leakage to make past trading decisions appear more accurate.
- External datasets, pretrained models, or AI tools may be used only if permitted by the organisers and disclosed when required.
- The organisers should announce the market instruments, data frequency, starting virtual capital, and trading constraints before the clock starts.

SECTION 05

5. Fair Play: Anti-Cheating and Team Conduct

> Fair competition is mandatory. Violations may be reviewed against timestamps, submissions, logs, and platform records.

- **No sharing strategies between competing teams.** Teams must not exchange source code, model files, prompts, features, parameters, trading signals, or strategy ideas during the competition unless the organisers explicitly allow it.
- **No copying another team's work.** Do not copy, reproduce, or submit another team's code or strategy as your own. Do not inspect another team's screen, files, account, or workspace without permission.
- **No coordinated trading or collusion.** Teams must work independently and must not coordinate actions or manipulate results to benefit one another.
- **No hidden-data access.** Do not access, leak, or infer from unauthorised sources, or attempt to obtain the final hidden dataset or evaluation outputs before the permitted evaluation.
- **No falsifying results.** Do not alter logs, fabricate backtests, manipulate reported performance, or misrepresent the origin of code, data, or models.
- **No platform abuse.** Do not attack, disrupt, overload, or exploit the competition platform or another team's environment.
- **Respect collaboration rules.** Use of public open-source code, online resources, or AI assistants must follow the organiser's announced policy. Disclose assistance and third-party material when required.

SECTION 06

6. Strategy and Trading Constraints

- Strategies may be rule-based, statistical, machine-learning-based, or hybrid.
- All trades must be generated through the approved competition interface.
- Follow all announced limits on position size, leverage, short selling, order frequency, and permitted instruments.
- Transaction costs, slippage, and other execution assumptions will follow the official simulator settings.
- If a phase is designated fully automated, no manual intervention is allowed during that phase.
- Submissions must run within the stated time, memory, and compute limits.

SECTION 07

7. Submission Requirements

- Submit the required source code and dependency or setup files.
- Include brief instructions for running the strategy and a concise explanation of its logic.
- Provide any requested configuration, performance summary, and disclosure of external resources or AI assistance.
- Submit before the announced deadline. Late, incomplete, or non-executable submissions may be penalized or rejected under the announced policy.
- After the deadline, do not replace or modify a submission unless organisers permit it.

SECTION 08

8. Evaluation and Ranking

> High training performance alone does not guarantee a high final rank. The final test uses unseen data or a controlled simulation.

- All eligible teams must be evaluated using the same initial capital, data conditions, trading rules, and cost assumptions.
- The final evaluation should use an unseen dataset or controlled simulation that teams cannot access in advance.
- The organisers must announce the scoring formula and tie-break rules before the final evaluation.
- Recommended metrics include net return after costs, risk-adjusted return, maximum drawdown, consistency, and rule compliance.
- High training performance alone does not guarantee a high final rank.
- Organisers should preserve evaluation logs so results can be checked if a dispute arises.

SECTION 09

9. Violations, Penalties, and Appeals

- Depending on severity, a violation may result in a warning, score penalty, invalidated submission, or disqualification.
- Suspected cheating should be reviewed using available evidence, such as timestamps, submissions, logs, and platform records.
- Teams may be asked to explain their work or demonstrate that their submission runs as claimed.
- A team may raise a concern or appeal through the process and deadline announced by the organisers.
- Organisers should apply the rules consistently to every team. Final decisions and any appeal procedure should be communicated clearly.

SECTION 10

10. Winners and Recognition

- Winners are determined by the published final scoring method after eligibility and rule-compliance checks.
- First, second, and third places go to the highest-ranked eligible teams.
- Special awards for innovation, risk management, or implementation may be given only if their criteria are announced.
- The organisers may withhold or revise an award if a submission is later found to violate the rules, following a fair review.

SECTION 11

11. Organiser Announcements

- Before the competition begins, organisers should communicate the registration and submission deadlines, official datasets and software environment, permitted resources, trading constraints, scoring formula, evaluation process, technical-failure policy, and contact person for questions. Any rule change must be announced to all teams and must not selectively favor a team.

SECTION 12

12. Participant Agreement

- By participating in the AI Trading Arena, every team agrees to follow this rulebook, respect other teams, protect confidential evaluation materials, submit work honestly, and compete fairly. Teams are responsible for understanding the rules before submitting their strategy.

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